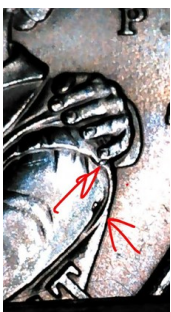


The Phantom of LaRose

A proposed die progression on the 2026-P Mayflower quarter — one-page brief for expert review

Prepared September 17, 2026. Framed throughout as the researcher's proposal — not a concluded attribution.

Die-1 markers — obverse (pilgrim side), 2026-P study photos



Mosquito Bite

Raised dot on the pilgrim's arm.

Study photos 001, 002, 003, 005, 006.



Splenter

Thin raised line at the hand.

Study photo 003.



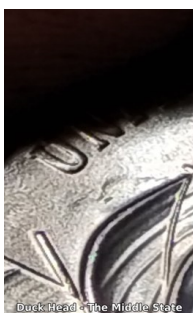
Ant Bite

Small dot at the fingers.

Study photos 003, 006.

Possible Mosquito Bite dots on three First-500 close-ups (104–106) could not be confirmed at available resolution — not claimed.

Phantom stages — reverse (ship side), proposed progression (July 2026 scope stills)



Duck Head

Die chip forms at the front of the foremast.



Half Phantom

Chip grows into a partial figure.



Full Phantom

Bird-like figure fully formed at the mast front.

A 542-image audit of the First-500 album found no further phantom-stage examples — consistent with a single-die event, but one-die identity across stages is not yet proven.

Against the listing bar (Cherrypickers' Guide, 6th ed., Vol. 2)

- Pick-Up Points — three named, photographed obverse diagnostics
 - **documented**
- Die-stage progression — three reverse stages photographed in sequence
 - **proposed; needs expert confirmation of single-die identity**
- Multiple specimens / die identity — markers repeat across study photos; no second confirmed marker coin in First-500 audit
 - **in progress**
- Clear enlarged photos of each diagnostic
 - **attached**
- Interest & liquidity — die events in this exact zone noted in CoinWeek, Sept 2026; market value unestablished
 - **interest yes / value no**

The question

"Is this — three obverse die markers plus a three-stage reverse die event on 2026-P Mayflower quarters — attributable as one working die's life, and what would it take to make it listable?"

Independent review requested. Researcher Pete Apple (CoinWeek) reads these features as die flow waves, not a crack progression, and sees no established value; his Sept 2026 article notes similar evolving die events in front of the foresail on 2026-P Mayflower quarters. This brief presents the proposer's evidence for a second expert opinion — no claim of one proven die, full proof, or dollar value.